

MAYRA SÁENZ

Citizenship: Ecuadorian
Italian Residence Permit

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AFFILIATION

Assistant Professor in Economics, Universidad del Rosario 2024 -

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Household and Demographic Economics, Development Economics

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics, University of Illinois (UIUC) 2024

with Minor in *Gender Relations in International Development*

M.A. in Development Economics, Latin American Faculty of Social Sciences (FLACSO) 2011

B.Sc. in Marketing Engineering, Armed Forces Polytechnic School (ESPE) 2009

SKILLS

Software: STATA, SPSS, R

Language: English (Proficient), Spanish (Native), Italian (Advanced)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank - Social Protection and Health 2024

Research Assistant, Prof. Arends-Kuenning, UIUC 2022 - 2024

Research Assistant, Prof. Pflugh Prescott and Prof. Ellison, UIUC 2021 - 2023

Consultant, World Bank - Nicaragua Country Office (Summer job) 2022

Consultant, World Bank - DECPI 2019 - 2021

Research Assistant, Prof. Michelson, UIUC 2019

Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank - Social Sector (Summer job) 2018

Social Research Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank - Social Sector 2013-2017

Researcher, FLACSO - Department of Economics 2011-2013

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Graduate Teacher Certificate. The Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning.
UIUC 2022

Manage Successful Impact Evaluation Surveys course. Auditor Certificate.
World Bank 2021

Multidimensional Poverty Analysis. Oxford Poverty and Human Development Initiative (OPHI)
University of Oxford 2016

Labor Markets, Poverty and Inequality. Center for Distributive, Labor and Social Studies (CEDLAS)
University of La Plata 2012

WORKING PAPERS

“Care Dependence and Hospitalizations: Evidence from the Mexican Health and Aging Study” (with M. Stampini and N. Aranco), Inter-American Development Bank, 2025.

Can Institutional Factors Affect Intergenerational Family Transfers?

The Effect of Monetary Losses from Weather Shocks on Food Security in Malawi: A Subjective Approach, 2020.

Analysis of the tax reform in Ecuador, 2001-2012. (with V. Aguiar and L. Castro). *Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean*. Macroeconomics of the Development Series No.143, 2013.

Ex-ante impacts of three commercial agreements in the Ecuadorian economy (with V. Aguiar and H. Jacome). *Linea Sur Magazine*, 2012.

WORK IN PROGRESS

“The Impact of Food Taxes and Front-of-Package Labeling on Wages and Employment in Colombia” (with P. Rodríguez-Lesmes, L. Gómez, M. Mora, N. Maldonado, L. Smith Taillie).

“Pathways into single motherhood and their implications for children’s wellbeing in Nicaragua” (with M. Arends-Kuenning and C. Herrera).

“To waste or not to waste? Exploring the complexity of student dietary behaviors in school cafeterias” (with M. Pflugh Prescott, B. Ellison, R. Ofori, S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

“Students’ peer effects on food selection and consumption” (with M. Pflugh Prescott, B. Ellison, R. Ofori, S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

“An agent-based model of the school cafeteria and meal patterns: Feedback of school nutrition stakeholders” (with M. Pflugh Prescott, B. Ellison, R. Ofori, S. Palmer, and I. Ciubotariu).

JOURNAL ARTICLES

MealSim: Data-Driven Predictions of Child Selection, Consumption, and Waste Behaviors to Promote Increased Fruit and Vegetable Consumption (with M. Prescott, B. Ellison, R. Ofori, I. Ciubotariu, and S. Palmer) *Journal of Nutrition Education and Behavior*, 55(7), 111., 2023.

Poverty, vulnerability, and the middle class in Latin America (with M. Stampini, M. Robles, P. Ibarraran, and N. Medellín). *Latin American Economic Review*, 2016.

BOOK CHAPTERS

Intergenerational persistence in education, (with M. Robles). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Social Pulse in Latin America and the Caribbean 2017: Family Legacy, Breaking the Mold or Repeating Patterns?* (pp. 12-41). Inter-American Development Bank.

Indicators of context and indicators of outcome, (with S. Duryea, S. Insfrán, M. Robles, V. Saldarriaga and D. Zuluaga). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Social Pulse in Latin America and the Caribbean 2017: Family Legacy, Breaking the Mold or Repeating Patterns?* (pp. 84-140). Inter-American Development Bank.

Indicators of context and indicators of outcome, (with S. Duryea, M. Robles, M. Rubio, and D. Saric). In S. Duryea and M. Robles (Ed). *Latin American and Caribbean Social Pulse 2016: realities and perspectives* (pp. 25-63). Inter-American Development Bank.

The case of Ecuador, (with L. Czarniecki and E. Balleza). *Poverty and inequality in Ecuador, Brazil, and Mexico after the 2008 global crisis*. Peter Lang GmbH, Internationaler Verlag der Wissenschaften.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

<i>Communicating Economics</i> (Undergraduate), Universidad del Rosario, Instructor	2025
<i>Behavioral Economics</i> (Undergraduate), Universidad del Rosario, Instructor	2025
<i>World Food Economy</i> (Undergraduate), UIUC, Teaching Assistant	2019 - 2022
<i>Behavioral Economics</i> (Undergraduate), UIUC, Teaching Assistant	2020
<i>Development Economics Thesis Advisor</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Instructor	2012 - 2013
<i>Quantitative Methods</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2012
<i>Political Economy for Development</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2012
<i>Applied Statistics Workshop</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2011
<i>General Algebraic Modeling System Workshop</i> (Graduate), FLACSO, Teaching Assistant	2011

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

2025 - Population Association of America (PAA), Virtual International Conference on Aging in the Americas (ICAA), International Conference on Aging in the Americas (ICAA).

2024 - University of El Rosario, Population Association of America (PAA)- Applied Demographic Conference (ADC), Workshop on Determinants of Adult Mortality, Morbidity, and Healthy Aging in LMICs at The Berkeley Center on the Economics and Demography of Aging (CEDA), Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev), Annual Meeting of the Southern Economic Association (SEA), International Conference on Aging in the Americas (ICAA).

2023 - Population Association of America (PAA), Sociology Colloquia Seminar, Center for Global Studies (CGS) Webinar, Gender Relations in International Development (GRID) Seminar, Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association (LACEA)

2020 - Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (AAEA)

2013 - Swiss Sociological Association Conference (University of Bern)

OTHER PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

<i>President</i> , Agricultural and Consumer Economics (ACE) Graduate Student Organization, UIUC	2020 - 2021
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SCHOLARSHIPS, HONORS AND AWARDS

Conference Travel Award, UIUC (<i>Summer, Fall</i>)	2023
Award for the Most Outstanding Second Year Research Paper, UIUC	2019
Chester Bull Roberts Fellowship, UIUC	2018
M. Frances Henry Fellowship, UIUC	2017 - 2018
Merit-based Fellowship, MA in Development Economics, FLACSO	2009-2011
Award for the Most Outstanding Student in Marketing Engineering, ESPE	2009
Academic Excellence Scholarship, ESPE	2004 - 2008